ABSTRACT

This study explores the cyber hygiene practices among college students and faculty, emphasizing the importance of maintaining digital security in academic environments. Using a mixed-methods approach with surveys and interviews, the research highlights general awareness of cyber hygiene, common behaviors, and preferred learning methods. Findings reveal that most respondents understand cyber hygiene, frequently update software, secure devices with lock screens, and cautiously use public Wi-Fi. Social media scams are perceived as the most prevalent cyber threat. While respondents rely primarily on online resources and social media for cyber safety information, they prefer structured training through online modules and expert-led sessions. Despite widespread awareness, confidence in personal cyber hygiene practices remains moderate, indicating a need for enhanced training programs. The study recommends implementing regular, targeted cybersecurity awareness initiatives focusing on social media safety, secure communication, and proactive device management to strengthen the overall security posture of academic institutions.

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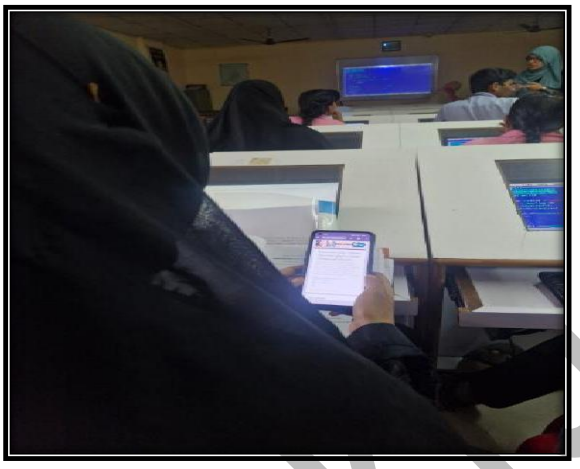

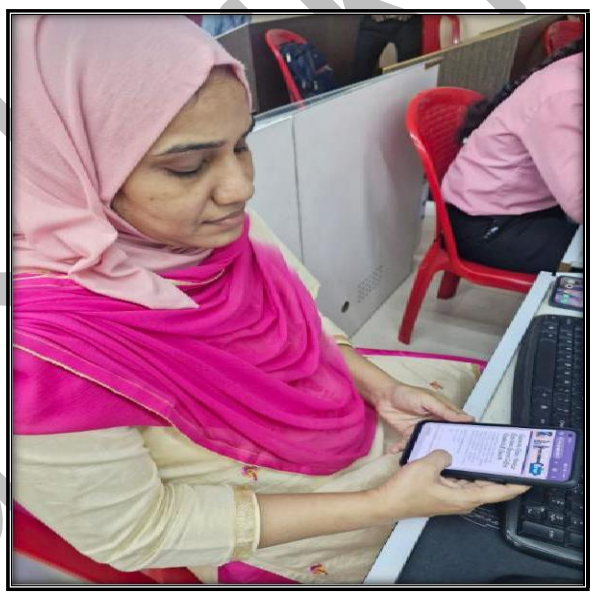

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

Cyber hygiene refers to the routine practices and precautions individuals take to maintain the health and security of their digital devices and data. These practices include creating strong, unique passwords, regularly updating software, being cautious about suspicious emails or links, backing up data, and using secure networks. Despite the widespread availability of security tools and awareness campaigns, many users—especially in academic settings—may not consistently follow these basic cyber hygiene principles, either due to lack of awareness, complacency, or underestimation of cyber risks.

College environments, in particular, present unique cybersecurity challenges. Students often use multiple devices and networks, including public Wi-Fi, which can increase vulnerability. Faculty members may handle confidential academic records or intellectual property, which require strict protection measures.

Given these factors, it is crucial to understand the current cyber hygiene practices among both students and faculty to identify gaps and areas for improvement. Everyone need to maintaining good cyber hygiene.

The findings from this survey will help educational institutions develop targeted cybersecurity training programs, promote safer online habits, and implement policies that enhance the overall security posture of the campus. Ultimately, improving cyber hygiene practices among college students and faculty not only protects individual users but also strengthens the security of the entire academic ecosystem.

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CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

Since 2025:

1.Human factors in remote work: examining cyber hygiene practices T Karayel, B Aktaş, A Akbıyık - Information & Computer Security, 2025 - emerald.com

2. A Comprehensive Review of Cyber Hygiene Practices in the Workplace for Enhanced Digital Security

S Armoogum, V Armoogum, A Chandra, DA Dewi… - … : International Journal on …, 2025 - joiv.org

Sort by relevance:

1.A Comprehensive Review of Cyber Hygiene Practices in the Workplace for Enhanced Digital Security

S Armoogum, V Armoogum, A Chandra, DA Dewi… - … : International Journal on …, 2025 - joiv.org

2. ASSESSMENT OF CYBER HYGIENE AWARENESS AND PERCEPTION AMONG PRIMARY SCHOOL TEACHERS IN KWARA STATE, NIGERIA

K ABDULFATTAH, C ASIYANBOLA… - … Online Journal of …, 2025 - nojest.unilag.edu.ng

Sort by date:

1. … NET: INTEGRATING CYBERSECURITY FUNDAMENTALS INTO CORE INFORMATION LITERACY CURRICULA IN NIGERIAN UNIVERSITIES–A CRITICAL REVIEW

T BALA, U Hassan, HS Yusuf - Journal of Institutional Research, Big …, 2025 - jirbdai.com.ng

Review articles:

Smart hygiene solutions for university campuses: Harnessing internet of things (IoT) for health and safety

ME Rana, K Shanmugam, OC Xian… - AIP Conference …, 2024 - pubs.aip.org

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CHAPTER 3: METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research method

The research employed a mixed method approach, combining both quantitative and qualitative techniques to gain a comprehensive understanding of cyber hygiene practices among college students and faculty.

3.2 Tool used

1. Questionnaire:-A structured set of questions designed to gather data on the awareness, habits, and behaviors related to cyber hygiene among students and faculty.

2. Interview:-Online interview questions asked to students and faculty to gain deeper insights into their preferences.

3. Software/Apps:-Tools like google forms for data collection and excel for organizing and analyzing responses.

3.3 Sampling size:

The sample size for the survey consisted of **20 participants**, including both college students and faculty members.

3.4 Sampling Method:

1. Convenience Sampling : Participants are selected based on easy accessibility and willingness to participate, such as students and faculty available during class or online sessions.

2. Purposive Sampling : We chosen specific individuals who had knowlwdge about the topic.

3. Quota Sampling : Participants are selected to reflect certain characteristics in proportion, like ensuring equal numbers from each department or year

Snowball Sampling : We asked participants to share the survey with others to increase responses.

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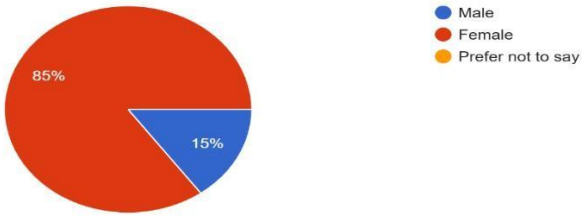
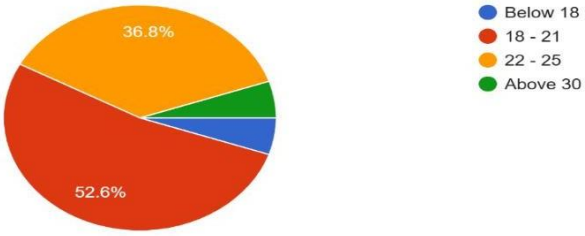
3.5 Data Analysis

GENDER
20 responses

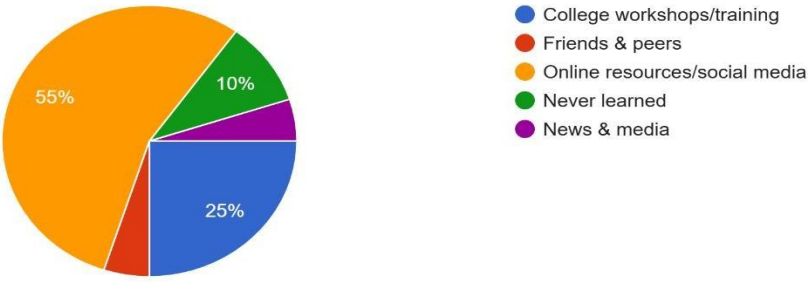


Age
19 responses



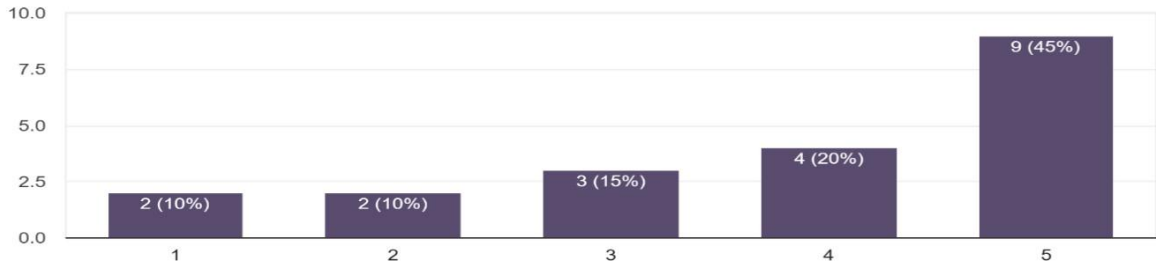
How familiar are you with the concept of Cyber Hygiene?
20 responses

Where do you mostly learn about cyber safety?
20 responses



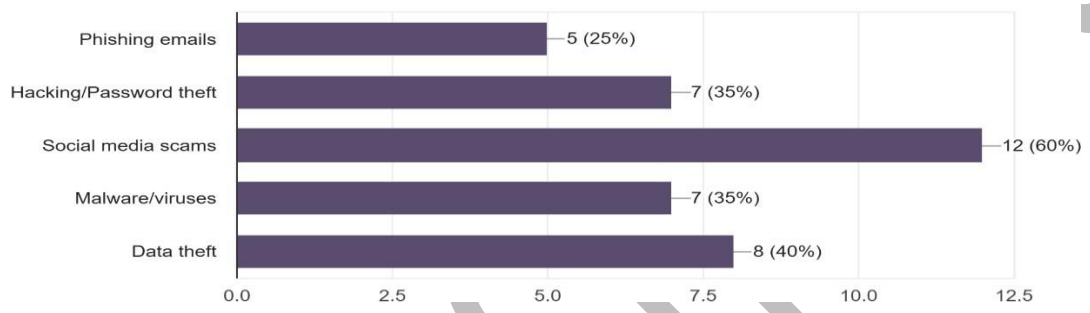
How would you rate the importance of cyber hygiene in your daily digital life?

20 responses



Which cyber threats do you think are most common among students/faculty?

20 responses



How often do you update your device software and apps?

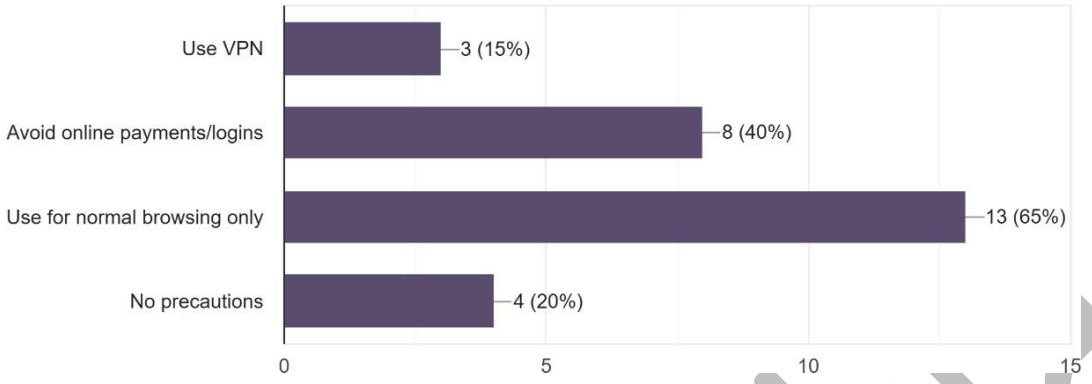
20 responses

What steps do you take to secure your personal devices?

20 responses

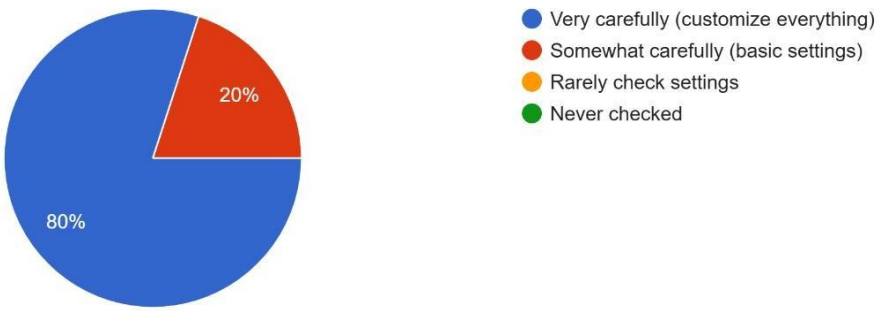
When using public Wi-Fi, what precautions do you take?

20 responses



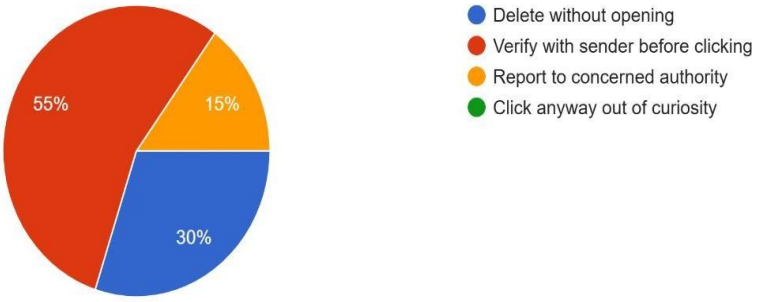
How carefully do you manage your social media privacy settings?

20 responses



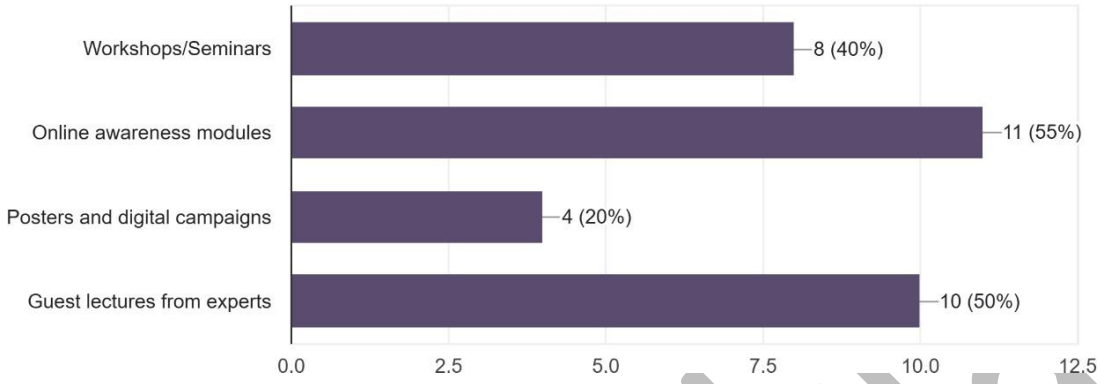
How do you respond when you receive suspicious links or messages?

20 responses



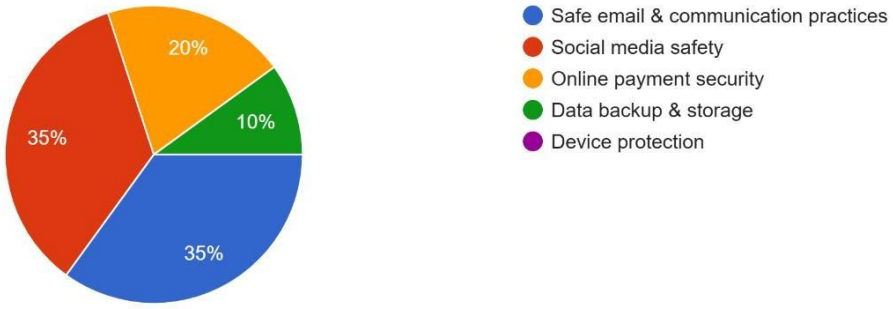
Which type of training/awareness programs would you prefer in your college?

20 responses



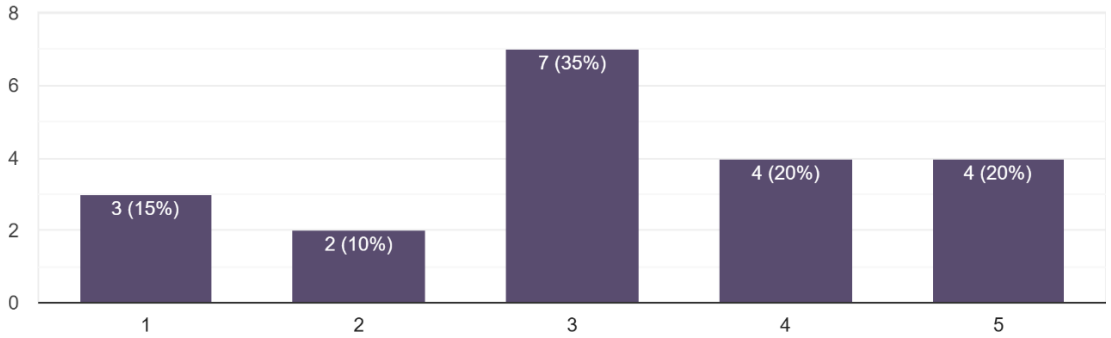
Which areas of cyber hygiene should be prioritized in academic settings?

20 responses



How would you rate your personal cyber hygiene practices on a scale of 1–5?

20 responses



CHAPTER 4: FIELD WORK, OBSERVATIONS, & ANALYSIS

4.1 Field Work Description

During my field work on cyber hygiene practices among college students and faculty, I conducted a detailed survey to understand their awareness and habits regarding online safety. I created a Google Form comprising questions related to password management, use of antivirus software, awareness of phishing attacks, and safe browsing behaviors. The survey was distributed digitally to a diverse group of participants, allowing me to collect responses efficiently. Analyzing the data helped me identify common gaps in cyber hygiene knowledge and practices, highlighting the need for increased awareness programs within the college community. This hands-on experience not only improved my understanding of cyber hygiene but also enhanced my skills in survey design and data collection. The collected data was automatically organized and stored via Google Forms for analysis.

4.2 Observation

During my online survey on cyber hygiene among college students and faculty, I observed that students often had weaker password habits and less awareness of phishing threats. Faculty members showed better security practices but still lacked full understanding of safe data management. Both groups recognized the importance of cyber hygiene but did not consistently apply it. This highlighted the need for improved awareness and training.

While sharing the survey and encouraging responses, I heard several participants mention that they found the topic relevant and timely, especially given the rise in online scams and data breaches.

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4.3 Analysis

Majorly respondents indicated that they are familiar with the concept of cyber hygiene.

Majorly respondents reported that they mostly learn about cyber safety from online resources and social media.

Majorly respondents rated the importance of cyber hygiene in their daily life as 5 on a scale of 1 to 5.

Majorly respondents social media scams as the most common cyber threat.

Majorly respondents reported that they update their device software and apps immediately after an update is available.

Majorly respondents indicated that they secure their personal devices by using a lock screen with PIN, pattern, or fingerprints.

Majorly stated that when using public Wi-Fi, they limit their activity to normal browsing only.

Majorly reported that they manage their social media privacy settings very carefully.

Majorly respondents indicated that they verify with the sender before clicking on suspicious links or messages.

Majorly respondents preferred online awareness modules and guest lectures from experts as their preferred types of training and awareness programs in college.

Majorly respondents identified social media safety and safe email & communication practices as the key areas of cyber hygiene to prioritize in academic settings.

Majorly respondents rated their personal cyber hygiene practices as 3, indicating an average level of confidence, while 20% rated themselves a 5, showing that a smaller group feels highly confident about their practices.

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CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Conclusion:

They largely practice safe behaviors such as updating devices promptly, securing devices with locks, limiting activity on public Wi-Fi, managing privacy settings carefully, and verifying suspicious links before engaging. Online resources and social media are their primary sources of learning, while they prefer structured awareness modules and expert-led sessions for deeper training. Key focus areas to be prioritized in academic settings include social media safety and secure communication practices. Although awareness and adoption of good practices are evident, respondents rated their confidence at an average level, indicating the need for more consistent training to strengthen cyber hygiene practices, with only a small proportion feeling highly confident.

Recommendation:

Based on the survey on cyber hygiene practices among college students and faculty, it is recommended that institutions implement regular **cybersecurity awareness programs** that combine online learning modules with expert-led workshops to strengthen both knowledge and confidence in safe practices. Special emphasis should be placed on **social media safety, secure email communication, and handling of suspicious links**, as these were identified as key areas of concern. Additionally, colleges should promote a **culture of proactive digital responsibility** by encouraging timely software updates, secure device management, and cautious use of public Wi-Fi. Establishing clear **policies and support systems** for reporting cyber incidents can further empower students and faculty, ensuring that awareness translates into consistent and confident cyber hygiene practices.

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- **Chatgpt link:**
- https://chat.openai.com
- **Google scholar link:**
- https://scholar.google.com
- **Perplexity link:**
- https://www.perplexity.ai/

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